



Maintain quality customer/guest service

D1.HCS.CL6.03 D2.TRM.CL9.12
D1.HML.CL10.07 D1.HRM.CL9.06

Assessor Manual



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Assessor Manual



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Competency Based Assessment (CBA) – An introduction for assessors

Assessment is the process of identifying a participant's current knowledge, skills and attitudes sets against all elements of competency within a unit of competency.

Suggested assessment methods

For each unit of competency a number of assessment tools have been identified including:

- Work Projects
- Oral Questions
- Written Questions
- Third Party Statements
- Observation Checklists.

Instructions and Evidence Recording Sheets have been identified in this Assessment Manual for use by Assessors.

Alternative assessment methods

Whilst the above mentioned assessment methods are suggested assessment methods, the assessor may use an alternate method of assessment taking into account:

- a) The nature of the unit
- b) The strengths of participants
- c) The number of participants in the class
- d) Time required to complete assessments
- e) Time dedicated to assessment
- f) Equipment and resources required.

Alternate assessment methods include:

- Practical demonstrations
- Practical demonstrations in simulated work conditions
- Problem solving
- Portfolios of evidence
- Critical incident reports
- Journals
- Oral presentations
- Interviews
- Videos
- Visuals/slides/audiotapes
- Log books
- Projects and Role plays

- Group projects
- Recognition of Prior Learning.

Whilst there is no specific instruction or evidence collection documents for all the alternative assessment methods, assessors can record competency in the 'Other' section within the 'Competency Recording Sheet'.

Selection of assessment methods

Each assessor will determine the combination of Assessment Methods to be used to determine Competency for each Competency Unit on a student by student basis.

'Sufficient' evidence to support the 'Pass Competent'/'Not Yet Competent' decision must be captured.

In practice this means a minimum of 2 – 3 Assessment Methods for each candidate for each Competency Element is suggested.

At least one method should provide evidence of practical demonstration of competence.

The following assessment methods deemed to provide evidence of practical demonstration of competence include:

- Practical Work Projects
- Third Party Statement
- Observation Checklist.

Assessing competency

Competency based assessment does not award grades, but simply identifies if the participant has the knowledge, skills and attitudes to undertake the required task to the specified standard.

Therefore, when assessing competency, an assessor has two possible results that can be awarded:

- 'Pass Competent' (PC)
- 'Not Yet Competent' (NYC).

Pass Competent (PC)

If the participant is able to successfully answer or demonstrate what is required, to the expected standards of the performance criteria, they will be deemed as 'Pass Competent' (PC).

The assessor will award a 'Pass Competent' (PC) if they feel the participant has the necessary knowledge, skills and attitudes in all assessment tasks for a unit.

Not Yet Competent' (NYC)

If the participant is unable to answer or demonstrate competency to the desired standard, they will be deemed to be 'Not Yet Competent' (NYC).

This does not mean the participant will need to complete all the assessment tasks again. The focus will be on the specific assessment tasks that were not performed to the expected standards.

The participant may be required to:

- a) Undertake further training or instruction
- b) Undertake the assessment task again until they are deemed to be 'Pass Competent'.

Regional Qualifications Framework and Skills Recognition System

The 'Regional Qualifications Framework and Skills Recognition System', also known as the 'RQFSRS' is the overriding educational framework for the ASEAN region.

The purpose of this framework is to provide:

- A standardised teaching and assessment framework
- Mutual recognition of participant achievement across the ASEAN region. This includes achievement in individual Units of Competency or qualifications as a whole.

The role of the 'RQFSRS' is to provide, ensure and maintain 'quality assurance' across all countries and educational providers across the ASEAN region.

Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL)

Recognition of Prior Learning is the process that gives current industry professionals who do not have a formal qualification, the opportunity to benchmark their extensive skills and experience against the standards set out in each unit of competency/subject.

This process is a learning and assessment pathway which encompasses:

- Recognition of Current Competencies (RCC)
- Skills auditing
- Gap analysis and training
- Credit transfer.

Code of practice for assessors

This Code of Practice provides:

- Assessors with direction on the standard of practice expected of them
- Candidates with assurance of the standards of practice expected of assessors
- Employers with assurance of the standards maintained in the conduct of assessment.

The Code detailed below is based on the International Code of Ethics and Practice (The National Council for Measurement in Education [NCME]):

- The differing needs and requirements of the person being assessed, the local enterprise and/or industry are identified and handled with sensitivity
- Potential forms of conflict of interest in the assessment process and/or outcomes are identified and appropriate referrals are made, if necessary
- All forms of harassment are avoided throughout the planning, conducting, reviewing and reporting of the assessment outcomes

- The rights of the candidate are protected during and after the assessment
- Personal and interpersonal factors that are not relevant to the assessment of competency must not influence the assessment outcomes
- The candidate is made aware of rights and process of appeal
- Evidence that is gathered during the assessment is verified for validity, reliability, authenticity, sufficiency and currency
- Assessment decisions are based on available evidence that can be produced and verified by another assessor
- Assessments are conducted within the boundaries of the assessment system policies and procedures
- Formal agreement is obtained from both the candidate and the assessor that the assessment was carried out in accordance with agreed procedures
- The candidate is informed of all assessment reporting processes prior to the assessment
- The candidate is informed of all known potential consequences of decisions arising from an assessment, prior to the assessment
- Confidentiality is maintained regarding assessment results
- The assessment results are used consistently with the purposes explained to the candidate
- Opportunities are created for technical assistance in planning, conducting and reviewing assessment procedures and outcomes.

Instructions and checklist for assessors

Instructions

General instructions for the assessment:

- Assessment should be conducted at a scheduled time that has been notified to the candidate
- Facilitators must ensure participants are made aware of the need to complete assessments and attend assessment sessions
- If a participant is unable to attend a scheduled session, they must make arrangements with the Assessor to undertake the assessment at an alternative time
- At the end of the assessment the Assessor must give feedback and advise the participant on their PC/NYC status
- Complete the relevant documentation and submit to the appropriate department.

Preparation

- Gain familiarity with the Unit of Competency, Elements of Competency and the Performance Criteria expected
- Study details assessment documentation and requirements
- Brief candidate regarding all assessment criteria and requirements.

Briefing checklist

- Begin the assessment by implementing the following checklist and then invite the candidate to proceed with assessment.

Checklist for Assessors

	Tick (✓)	Remarks
Prior to the assessment I have:		
Ensured the candidate is informed about the venue and schedule of assessment.		
Received current copies of the performance criteria to be assessed, assessment plan, evidence gathering plan, assessment checklist, appeal form and the company's standard operating procedures (SOP).		
Reviewed the performance criteria and evidence plan to ensure I clearly understood the instructions and the requirements of the assessment process.		
Identified and accommodated any special needs of the candidate.		
Checked the set-up and resources for the assessment.		
During the assessment I have:		
Introduced myself and confirmed identities of candidates.		
Put candidates at ease by being friendly and helpful.		
Explained to candidates the purpose, context and benefits of the assessment.		
Ensured candidates understood the assessment process and all attendant procedures.		
Provided candidates with an overview of performance criteria to be assessed.		
Explained the results reporting procedure.		
Encouraged candidates to seek clarifications if in doubt.		
Asked candidates for feedback on the assessment.		
Explained legal, safety and ethical issues, if applicable.		

	Tick (✓)	Remarks
After the assessment I have:		
Ensured candidate is given constructive feedback.		
Completed and signed the assessment record.		
Thanked candidate for participating in the assessment.		

Instructions for recording competency

Specifications for recording competency

The following specifications apply to the preparation of Evidence Gathering Plans:

- A Competency Recording Sheet must be prepared for each candidate to ensure and demonstrate all Performance Criteria and Competency Elements are appropriately assessed. This Sheet indicates how the Assessor will gather evidence during their assessment of each candidate
- This Competency Recording Sheet is located at the end of the Assessment Plan
- It is the overriding document to record competency
- The Assessor may vary the Competency Recording Sheet to accommodate practical and individual candidate and/or workplace needs
- Assessor must place a tick (✓) in the 'Assessment Method' columns to identify the methods of assessment to be used for each candidate
- Multiple Competency Elements/Performance Criteria may be assessed at the one time, where appropriate
- The assessor and participant should sign and date the Competency Recording Sheet, when all forms of evidence and assessment have been completed
- The assessor may provide and feedback or clarify questions which the participant may have in regards to the assessment grade or findings
- All documents used to capture evidence must be retained, and attached to the Competency Recording Sheet for each candidate for each Competency Unit.

Instructions for different assessment methods

Specifications for work project assessment

These guidelines concern the use of work projects.

The work projects identified in the Training Manuals involve a range of tasks, to be performed at the discretion of the Assessor.

Work project tasks can be completed through any form of assessment as identified in the Trainer and Trainee Manuals and stated at the start of this section.

Assessors should follow these guidelines:

- Review the Work Projects at the end of each 'Element of Competency' in the Trainee Manual to ensure you understand the content and what is expected

- Prepare sufficient resources for the completion of work activities including:
 - Time – whether in scheduled delivery hours or suggested time participants to spend outside of class hours
 - Resources – this may involve technical equipment, computer, internet access, stationery and other supplementary materials and documents
- Prepare assessment location (if done in class) making it conducive to assessment
- Explain Work Projects assessment to candidate, at the start of each Element of Competency. This ensures that participants are aware of what is expected and can collate information as delivery takes place
- Assessors can use the following phrase as a guide (where an 'X' is identified, please input appropriate information):

“At the end of each Element of Competency there are Work Projects which must be completed. These projects require different tasks that must be completed.

These work projects are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X:

 - You are required to complete these activities:
 - a) *Using the 'X' method of assessment*
 - b) *At 'X' location*
 - c) *You will have 'X time period' for this assessment*
 - You are required to compile information in a format that you feel is appropriate to the assessment
 - Do you have any questions about this assessment?”
- Commence Work Project assessment:
 - The assessor may give time for participants to review the questions at this time to ensure they understand the nature of the questions. The assessor may need to clarify questions
 - Participants complete work projects in the most appropriate format
 - Participants must submit Work Project evidence to the assessor before the scheduled due date
- Assessor must assess the participant's evidence against the competency standards specified in each Element of Competency and their own understanding. The assessor can determine if the participant has provided evidence to a 'competent' standard
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Oral Question Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of oral questioning.

Assessors should follow these guidelines.

- Prepare Assessment Record for Oral Questioning. One record for each candidate:
 - Enter Student name

- Enter Assessor name
- Enter Location
- Familiarise self with Questions to be asked
- Prepare assessment location (table and chairs) making it conducive to assessment
- Explain Oral Questioning assessment to candidate, using the following phrase as a guide (where a 'X' is identified, please input appropriate information):
"These oral questions are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X.
There are X questions and you are required to answer all of them to the best of your ability and I will record whether or not you have answered correctly.
We have 60 minutes for this assessment.
 - I will give you feedback at the end of the assessment
 - Do you have any questions about this assessment?"
- Commence Oral Questioning assessment:
 - Complete Assessment Record for the Oral Questioning by:
 - a) Ticking PC or NYC, as appropriate
 - b) Entering 'Remarks' as required
 - c) Completing Oral Questioning within 60 minutes
- Complete Oral Questioning and provide feedback to candidate
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Written Question Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of written questioning.

Assessors should follow these guidelines:

- Familiarise self with Questions and Answers provided
- Print and distribute copies of 'Written Questions' for participants. Ideally this should take place with adequate time for participants to answer all questions before the expected due date
- Explain Written Questioning assessment to candidate, using the following phrase as a guide (where a 'X' is identified, please input appropriate information):

"These written questions are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X.

There are X questions and you are required to answer all of them to the best of your ability.

You may refer to your subject materials, however where possible try to utilise your existing knowledge when answering questions.

Where you are unsure of questions, please ask the Assessor for further instruction. This may be answering the question orally or asking the assessor to redefine the question.

We have X time for this assessment:

- The due date for completion of this assessment is X
- On this date you must forward the completed questions to the assessor by X time on the date of X
- Do you have any questions about this assessment?”
- The assessor may give time for participants to review the questions at this time to ensure they understand the nature of the questions. The assessor may need to clarify questions
- Participants may record written answers (where possible)
- Participants must submit the written answers to the assessor before the scheduled due date
- Assessor must assess the participant’s written answers against the model answers provided as a guide, or their own understanding. The assessor can determine if the participant has answered the questions to a ‘competent’ standard
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Observation Checklist

These specifications apply to the use of the Observation Checklist in determining competency for candidates.

Only an approved assessor is authorised to complete the Observation Checklist.

The assessor is required to observe the participant, ideally in a simulated environment or their practical workplace setting and record their performance (or otherwise) of the competencies listed on the Observation Checklist for the Competency Unit.

To complete the Observation Checklist the Assessor must:

- Insert name of candidate
- Insert assessor name
- Insert identify of location where observations are being undertaken
- Insert date/s of observations – may be single date or multiple dates
- Place a tick in either the ‘Yes’ or ‘No’ box for each listed Performance Criteria to indicate the candidate has demonstrated/not demonstrated that skill
- Provide written (and verbal) feedback to candidate – as/if appropriate
- Sign and date the form
- Present form to candidate for them to sign and date
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet for candidate
- Forward/file Observation Checklist.

This source of evidence combines with other forms of assessment to assist in determining the ‘Pass Competent’ or ‘Not Yet Competent’ decision for the participant.

Specifications for Third Party Statement

These specifications relate to the use of a relevant workplace person to assist in determining competency for candidates.

The Third Party Statement is to be supplied by the assessor to a person in the workplace who supervises and/or works closely with the participant.

This may be their Supervisor, the venue manager, the Department Manager or similar.

The Third Party Statement asks the Supervisor to record what they believe to be the competencies of the participant based on their workplace experience of the participant. This experience may be gained through observation of their workplace performance, feedback from others, inspection of candidate's work etc.

A meeting must take place between the Assessor and the Third Party to explain and demonstrate the use of the Third Party Statement.

To complete the Third Party Verification Statement the Assessor must:

- Insert candidate name
- Insert name and contact details of the Third Party
- Tick the box to indicate the relationship of the Third Party to the candidate
- Present the partially completed form to the Third Party for them to finalise
- Collect the completed form from the Third Party
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet for candidate
- Forward/file Third Party Statement.

The Third Party must:

- Record their belief regarding candidate ability/competency as either:
 - Pass Competent = Yes
 - Not Yet Competent = No
 - Unsure about whether candidate is competent or not = Not Sure
- Meet briefly with the assessor to discuss and/or clarify the form.

This source of evidence combines with other forms of assessment to assist in determining the 'Pass Competent' or 'Not Yet Competent' decision for the candidate.

A separate Third Party Statement is required for each Competency Unit undertaken by the candidate.

Competency Standard

UNIT TITLE: MAINTAIN QUALITY CUSTOMER/GUEST SERVICE				NOMINAL HOURS: 35
UNIT NUMBER:	D1.HCS.CL6.03	D2.TRM.CL9.12	D1.HML.CL10.07	D1.HRM.CL9.06
UNIT DESCRIPTOR: This unit deals with the skills and knowledge required to maintain a quality customer/guest service in a range of settings within the hotel and travel industries.				
ELEMENTS AND PERFORMANCE CRITERIA		UNIT VARIABLE AND ASSESSMENT GUIDE		
Element 1: Identify customer/guest requirements 1.1 <i>Research</i> and assess needs of customers and/or guests 1.2 Conduct <i>data analysis</i> to identify deficiencies in service delivery 1.3 Identify options to improve <i>service levels</i> Element 2: Ensure delivery of quality products/services 2.1 Ensure products/services meet <i>customers' needs</i> and reflect enterprise standards 2.2 Ensure team performance consistently meets enterprise standards 2.3 Assist colleagues to meet and exceed customer service standards by providing <i>appropriate professional development</i>		Unit Variables The Unit Variables provide advice to interpret the scope and context of this unit of competence, allowing for differences between enterprises and workplaces. It relates to the unit as a whole and facilitates holistic assessment. This unit applies to maintaining a quality customer/guest service within the labour divisions of the hotel and travel industries and may include: 1. Front Office 2. Housekeeping 3. Food and Beverage Service 4. Food Production 5. Travel Agencies 6. Tour Operation <i>Research</i> may include: • Interviewing colleagues and clients		

Element 3: Evaluate customer service 3.1 Review customer/guest satisfaction with service delivery using <i>appropriate methods that produce verifiable data</i> 3.2 Compare systems, records and reporting procedures in order to identify and report on any changes in customer satisfaction 3.3 <i>Evaluate and report on customer service evaluation outcomes to designated groups or individuals</i> 3.4 Obtain agreement on appropriate course of action to take to overcome problems and adjust products and services in consultation with designated individuals or groups	• Focus groups • Data analysis • Product sampling • Sales data review. <i>Data analysis</i> may include: • Data sampling • Statistical analysis • Comparison between current and previous research. <i>Service levels</i> may relate to: • Service quality • Customer satisfaction • Staff attitude • Appearance of venue, staff, etc. • Atmosphere of venue • Responsiveness of staff to customer requests • Delivery times • Prices or costs • Product or service availability • Courtesy and politeness. <i>Customers' needs</i> may relate to: • Advice or general information • Specific information
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	• Complaints • Purchasing organization's products and services • Returning organization's products and services • Accuracy of information • Fairness/politeness • Prices/value. <i>Appropriate professional development may include:</i> • Mentoring • Coaching • Training • Peer support. <i>Appropriate methods that produce verifiable data may include:</i> • Mystery guest • Customer satisfaction survey • Customer/guest interviews • Representative sampling activities • Industry benchmarking. <i>Evaluate and report on customer service may relate to:</i> • Service quality evaluations • Customer satisfaction evaluations • Industry benchmarking.
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	<i>Designated groups or individuals</i> may relate to: • Owners • Board of directors • Managers • Supervisors • Marketing personnel. Assessment Guide The following knowledge and skills must be assessed as part of this unit: • Knowledge of the business environment in which the hotel and travel industry operates, including major current customer relations and management issues as appropriate to the industry sector • Ability to apply the principles of customer service • Knowledge of the organization's business structure, products and services and organization's policy and procedures for customer service, including handling customer complaints • Knowledge of product and service standards and best practice models • Knowledge of common problems relating to customer service • Knowledge of consultation methods, techniques and protocols • Knowledge of research and or evidence and feedback gathering techniques. Linkages To Other Units • Monitor workplace operations • Lead and manage people • Manage workplace diversity
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- Develop and implement a business plan
- Develop new products and services
- Manage and implement small projects
- Plan, and establish systems and procedures
- Plan, manage and conduct meetings
- Prepare business documents.

Critical Aspects of Assessment

Evidence of the following is essential:

- Demonstrated ability to identify the needs and priorities of the organization delivering services to customers/guests
- Demonstrated ability to distinguish between customer requirements and customer satisfaction
- Demonstrated ability to provide constructive advice on customer/guest service practices
- Demonstrated ability to respond to and report on customer feedback
- Demonstrated ability to design strategies to improve delivery of products and services
- Consistency of performance across a range of situations that demonstrates knowledge, understanding and skill in implementing the principles and practices of maintaining quality customer/guest services.

Context of Assessment

This unit may be assessed on or off the job:

- Assessment should include practical demonstration of the ability to maintain quality customer/guest services in the workplace or through a simulation activity, supported by a range of methods to assess underpinning knowledge

	• Assessment must relate to the individual's work area, job role and area of responsibility and require the candidate to identify customer satisfaction levels and make recommendations on how to improve or maintain current service levels • Assessment must include project or work activities that allow the candidate to respond to multiple and varying workplace issues relevant to work area, job role and area of responsibility that allow the candidate to demonstrate knowledge and awareness of maintaining quality customer/guest services. Resource Implications Training and assessment to include access to a real or simulated workplace and relevant documentation, such as strategic plans, information on the internal and external operating environment and customer satisfaction data; and access to workplace standards, procedures, policies, guidelines, tools and equipment. Assessment Methods The following methods may be used to assess competency for this unit: • Case studies • Observation of practical candidate performance • Oral and written questions • Portfolio evidence • Problem solving • Role plays • Third party reports completed by a supervisor • Project and assignment work.
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	Key Competencies in this Unit <i>Level 1 = competence to undertake tasks effectively</i> <i>Level 2 = competence to manage tasks</i> <i>Level 3 = competence to use concepts for evaluating</i>		
	Key Competencies	Level	Examples
	Collecting, organizing and analysing information	2	Gather and analyse information to measure customer satisfaction
	Communicating ideas and information	2	Present customer satisfaction evaluation to management
	Planning and organizing activities	2	Manage an annual review of customer satisfaction levels on products and services
	Working with others and in teams	2	Provide mentoring and/or coaching
	Using mathematical ideas and techniques	0	
	Solving problems	2	Identify service options to address customer enquiries or complaints
	Using technology	2	Generate customer satisfaction data

Oral Questions

Student name	
Assessor name	
Location/venue	
Unit of competency	Maintain quality customer/guest service D1.HCS.CL6.03 D2.TRM.CL9.12 D1.HML.CL10.07 D1.HRM.CL9.06
Instructions	1. Ask student questions from the attached list to confirm knowledge, as necessary 2. Place tick in boxes to reflect student achievement (Pass Competent 'PC' or Not Yet Competent 'NYC') 3. Write short-form student answer in the space provided for each question.

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
1. How do you research and assess the needs of customers/guests in your workplace?	☐	☐
2. Describe the way you analyse workplace data to determine how customers/guests rate the service delivery in your venue or business.	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
3. Tell me about an instance where you took action to address what your customers/guests believed to be sub-standard service levels: how did you become aware of the problem? What did you do to fix the issue?	☐	☐
4. What are the enterprise standards in your workplace regarding the provision of quality products and or services?	☐	☐
5. In relation to the provision of service in your workplace, what expectations does management have regarding service delivery personnel and teams?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
6. What professional development have you conducted, or participated in, to enhance delivery of service to workplace customers? Why was it conducted?	☐	☐
7. What techniques or methods do you use in the workplace to review customer/guest satisfaction levels with service provision?	☐	☐
8. What workplace systems, records or reporting procedures might you refer to in order to identify changes in customer/guest satisfaction levels with products and or services provided in your workplace?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
9. In your workplace, who do you report identified changes in customer/guest satisfaction with products and services to? How would you make such a report?	☐	☐
10. In your work role, who do you have to obtain permission or authorisation from in order to take action to address reduced levels of customer/guest satisfaction with venue products and or services?	☐	☐

Written Questions

**Maintain quality customer/guest service – D1.HCS.CL6.03 D2.TRM.CL9.12
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Student Name: _____

Answer all the following questions and submit to your Trainer.

1. How can you identify customer needs, wishes and expectations?

2. Answer 'True' or 'False' to the following statement: Staff are a very good source for obtaining customer feedback and information.

True ☐ False ☐

3. Explain the difference between informal and formal research providing an example of both.

4. When collecting research what is the difference between primary and secondary data?

5. When identifying ways to improve customer service, what are some ways to improve operations?

6. When identifying ways to improve customer service, how can you involve staff?

7. What types of service standards and guarantees can be developed?

8. How can you communicate service standards and guarantees to staff?

9. What are three characteristics of effective teams?

10. How can you monitor team performance?

11. Professional development is critical to the improvement of customer service. What is professional development and what are some types of professional development a staff member can undertake?

12. As a manager how can you provide support to staff?

13. What are the objectives of collecting and reviewing customer feedback?

14. What are four methods used to collect customer feedback?

15. After collecting customer feedback, normally this is compared against existing information to identify if improvements have taken place. What would you compare customer feedback against?

16. What are common serious problems found in service companies?

17. Who are three people you would report findings of customer service to?

18. Answer 'True' or 'False' to the following statement: When providing report findings, you should only mention negative feedback.

True ☐ False ☐

19. What are some suggested courses of action to overcome customer service problems?

20. What are some strategies you would use to ensure staff were aware of and understand desired changes to customer service?

Answers to Written Questions

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The following are model answers only – Trainers/Assessors must use discretion when determining whether or not an answer provided by a Student is acceptable or not.

1. How can you identify customer needs, wishes and expectations?

- Involve the customers in developing new services
- Organise and conduct a series of focus groups
- Actively listen to the customers
- Wear customer spectacles and see with the customer's eyes
- Actively look for customer feedback
- Ask customers what elements or factors of service are of particular importance to them
- Analyse the market trends.

2. Answer 'True' or 'False' to the following statement: Staff are a very good source for obtaining customer feedback and information.

The answer is true.

3. Explain the difference between informal and formal research providing an example of both.

Informal research is casual in nature and may include:

- Discussing information with colleague
- Seeking customer feedback by asking questions
- Personal observation of customers and service delivery and then self-reflection on what you have seen
- Discussing information with a wider network of contacts
- Discussing information with the public in public places
- Articles seen on TV or reading the newspaper, magazines or books.

Formal research is more structured and deliberate in nature and involves:

- Reading printed material from your property
- Enrolling in a specific course related to the area you want to find out about
- Reading product and service information brochures
- Surfing the Internet for information about a specific topic
- Visiting the library
- Developing, distributing and analysing questionnaires

- Attending conferences and seminars
- Attending product launches
- Attending Industry Associations functions.

4. When collecting research what is the difference between primary and secondary data?

Primary data is fresh, new, original information you discover, uncover, find or bring to light. Primary data is very useful as it is not only structured to finding out data that is specific to your organization; it allows you to gain a first-hand understanding and explanation of results.

Secondary data is information which already exists somewhere in the world. It could be within the organisation, or research conducted by another organization, but which you bring together to use to help shed light on the topic central to the research. Secondary data is a great tool to use when you are limited on time, require broader industry information and that which you could not collect yourself.

5. When identifying ways to improve customer service, what are some ways to improve operations?

- Create a competitive advantage over competition by either doing something different, more superior or cheaper
- New or revised products
- New services
- New menus
- Renovations
- New equipment with staff fully trained in their operations
- New marketing strategies to new target market segments
- New advertising campaigns with suitable attractive packages
- New branding to give the organisation a new and fresh approach
- Correct staffing level and mixes
- Recruitment
- Structured training programs
- Management
- Financial support
- Changes in management style
- Organisational re-structures
- Greater use of e-business
- Greater use of technology Environmental awareness.

6. When identifying ways to improve customer service, how can you involve staff?

- Creating and implanting the business concept
- Involving staff in planning and implementing quality improvement
- Building a spirit of working together towards goals
- Creating instruments and channels to disseminate the company's philosophy, goals and values throughout the organisation
- Promoting a climate of open communication and feedback
- Encouraging and recognising innovation and teamwork
- Recognising the right of every employee to understand the requirements of their assignment, and to be heard when offering suggestion for improvement.

7. What types of service standards and guarantees can be developed?

- Response times
- Service guarantees
- Pricing guarantees
- Product quality
- Document presentation standards
- Personal presentation standards
- Complaint management.

8. How can you communicate service standards and guarantees to staff?

- Orientation programs
- Formal meetings
- Staff briefings at the start and end of shifts
- Training sessions
- Observation and mentoring
- Informal communication during a shift.

9. What are three characteristics of effective teams?

- Clear goals
- Relevant skills
- Mutual trust
- Unified commitment
- Good communication
- Negotiating skills
- Appropriate leadership
- Internal and external support.

10. How can you monitor team performance?

Some suitable methods to monitoring team performance include:

- Observations
- Meetings
- Customer feedback
- Staff feedback
- Financial and operational reports
- Performance appraisals.

11. Professional development is critical to the improvement of customer service. What is professional development and what are some types of professional development a staff member can undertake?

Professional development, whilst normally comprising formal training, in essence can be classified as any activity that enables customers to improve their service delivery.

Types of professional development can include:

- Qualifications and certified training programs provided by external educational or professional providers
- Internal programs
- Meetings
- On the job learning
- Buddy system
- Research activities
- Demonstrations
- Discussions.

12. As a manager how can you provide support to staff?

Support that can be given to workplace teams may entail:

- Giving moral and verbal support
- Providing relevant training and coaching
- Obtaining more physical resources
- Getting approval for more time (overtime payments, extra hours)
- Advocating to management on behalf of the staff
- Supporting staff when an unfounded or unfair allegation is made about them
- Soliciting and listening to their feedback
- Thanking them for hard work, effort and when they go the extra yard or two
- Celebrating their successes.

13. What are the objectives of collecting and reviewing customer feedback?

- Identify the extent to which customers and others are satisfied (or not) with service delivery
- Identify the departments/areas in which there is satisfaction (or not) with service delivery
- Identify the precise areas within departments/areas where there is dissatisfaction.
- Identify the precise nature of any dissatisfaction
- Identify the staff involved in both superior and inferior levels of service
- Identify if there is a certain time of the day/week when service levels are reduced or at their best
- Discover what can be done to improve a less than optimum situation
- Identify what needs to be done to maintain the present satisfactory level of service delivery.

14. What are four methods used to collect customer feedback?

- Direct communication from customer to staff
- Observations
- Guest comment cards
- Online feedback
- Meetings.

15. After collecting customer feedback, normally this is compared against existing information to identify if improvements have taken place. What would you compare customer feedback against?

- Budgets
- Operational reports
- Standard Operating Procedures (SOP'S)
- Job Descriptions.

16. What are common serious problems found in service companies?

- Difficulties in contacting service staff
- Lack of information about the products and services offered by the establishment
- Unclear or incomplete price information
- Unclear or incomplete deals
- Handling of complaints
- The content and form of the bill.

17. Who are three people you would report findings of customer service to?

- Management
- The Board
- Certain subcommittees
- The establishment's focus group
- Trainers in the business
- External trainers
- Organisation
- All staff members
- Specific staff members who are identified by feedback
- Head office.

18. Answer 'True' or 'False' to the following statement: When providing report findings, you should only mention negative feedback.

The answer is false.

19. What are some suggested courses of action to overcome customer service problems?

- Give benefits to key customers
- Systematise customer complaints and learn from them
- Train staff in customer care
- Give staff the authority, discretion and resources to make quick decisions
- Stimulate employees to be creative in developing customer care activities
- Allow staff room to make mistakes
- Invest in meetings and regular contacts with customers
- Make it easy for customers to complain.

20. What are some strategies you would use to ensure staff were aware of and understand desired changes to customer service?

- Hold a formal staff meeting to inform staff of the
- Give staff a hard copy of the new service
- Explain the changes
- Give staff demonstrations of the new service delivery protocols
- Tell staff about the dates for introducing the new service procedures
- Reassure staff they are not required to implement the changes 'tomorrow'
- Inform staff of the training being provided to support them in implementing the new requirements

-
- Encourage questions from staff about the changes
 - Make yourself available outside this meeting for staff to talk to if they have concerns regarding the changes
 - Post new checklists relating to the changes in appropriate parts of the venue
 - Include new policies, procedures in operational manuals, induction programs and in-house training
 - Schedule staff to attend sessions to obtain necessary training to assist with implementation of the changes
 - Introduce the changes and monitor their implementation
 - Provide feedback to staff as appropriate including additional training where necessary.
-

Observation Checklist

Student name	
Assessor name	
Location/venue	
Unit of competency	Maintain quality customer/guest service D1.HCS.CL6.03 D2.TRM.CL9.12 D1.HML.CL10.07 D1.HRM.CL9.06
Dates of observation	
Instructions	- Over a period of time observe the student completing each of the following tasks: - Identify customer/guest requirements - Ensure delivery of quality products and services - Evaluate customer service - Enter the date on which the tasks were undertaken - Place a tick in the box to show they completed each aspect of the task to the standard expected in the enterprise - Complete the feedback sections of the form, if required.

Did the candidate	Yes	No
Element 1: Identify customer/guest requirements		
Research and assess needs of customers/guests	☐	☐
Conduct data analysis to identify deficiencies in service delivery	☐	☐
Identify options to improve service levels	☐	☐
Element 2: Ensure delivery of quality products and services		
Ensure products and services meet customers' needs and reflect enterprise standards	☐	☐
Ensure team performance consistently meets enterprise standards	☐	☐
Assist colleagues to meet and exceed customer service standards by providing appropriate professional development	☐	☐

Element 3: Evaluate customer service		
Review customer/guest satisfaction with service delivery using appropriate methods that produce verifiable data	☐	☐
Compare systems, records and reporting procedures in order to identify and report on any changes in customer satisfaction	☐	☐
Evaluate and report on customer service evaluation outcomes to designated groups or individuals	☐	☐
Obtain agreement on appropriate course of action to take to overcome problems and adjust products/services in consultation with designated individuals/groups	☐	☐
Did the student's overall performance meet the standard?	☐	☐

Feedback to student and trainer/assessor**Strengths:****Improvements needed:****General comments:****Candidate signature****Date****Assessor signature****Date**

Third Party Statement

Student name:			
Name of third party:		Contact no	
Relationship to student:	☐ Employer ☐ Supervisor ☐ Colleague ☐ Other Please specify: _____ <i>Please do not complete the form if you are a relative, close friend or have a conflict of interest]</i>		
Unit of competency:	Maintain quality customer/guest service D1.HCS.CL6.03 D2.TRM.CL9.12 D1.HML.CL10.07 D1.HRM.CL9.06		
The student is being assessed against industry competency standards and we are seeking your support in the judgement of their competence. Please answer these questions as a record of their performance while working with you. Thank you for your time.			
Do you believe the trainee has demonstrated the following skills? (tick the correct response]	Yes	No	Not sure
Researches, assesses and analyses needs of customers/guests and identifies deficiencies in service delivery and options to improve same	☐	☐	☐
Ensures products and services and team performance meet customers' needs and reflect enterprise standards	☐	☐	☐
Assists colleagues to meet and exceed customer service standards by providing appropriate professional development	☐	☐	☐
Reviews, evaluates and reports on customer/guest satisfaction with service delivery using appropriate methods that produce verifiable data	☐	☐	☐
Obtains agreement on appropriate action to take to overcome problems and adjust products and services in consultation with designated individuals or groups	☐	☐	☐

Comments/feedback from Third Party to Trainer/Assessor:

Third party signature:

Date:

Send to:

Competency Recording Sheet

Name of Student		
Name of Assessor/s		
Unit of Competency	Maintain quality customer/guest service	D1.HCS.CL6.03 D2.TRM.CL9.12 D1.HML.CL10.07 D1.HRM.CL9.06
Date assessment commenced		
Date assessment finalised		
Assessment decision	Pass Competent / Not Yet Competent (Circle one)	
Follow up action required (Insert additional work and assessment required to achieve competency)		
Comments/observations by assessor/s		

Place a tick (✓) in the column to reflect evidence obtained to determine Competency of the student for each Performance Criteria.

Element & Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Element 1: Identify customer/guest requirements						
Research and assess needs of customers and/or guests						
Conduct data analysis to identify deficiencies in service delivery						
Identify options to improve service levels						
Element 2: Ensure delivery of quality products/services						
Ensure products and services meet customers' needs and reflect enterprise standards						
Ensure team performance consistently meets enterprise standards						
Assist colleagues to meet and exceed customer service standards by providing appropriate professional development						

Place a tick (✓) in the column to reflect evidence obtained to determine Competency of the student for each Performance Criteria.

Element & Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Element 3: Evaluate customer service						
Review customer/guest satisfaction with service delivery using appropriate methods that produce verifiable data						
Compare systems, records and reporting procedures in order to identify and report on any changes in customer satisfaction						
Evaluate and report on customer service evaluation outcomes to designated groups or individuals						
Obtain agreement on appropriate course of action to take to overcome problems and adjust products and services in consultation with designated individuals or groups						
Candidate signature			Date			
Assessor signature			Date			

